

Aaron Micheal Scherf

Work Experience

USAID/Ukraine Program Office – MEL Team Lead (FS 3-5)

- **Winter Working Group:** Led interagency group to align generator distribution, humanitarian aid, and infrastructure repairs according to real-time data system based on OCHA and GOU inputs
- **M&E:** Managed portfolio of 16 completed or ongoing activity evaluations, including a \$1.5M impact evaluation; implement multi-tiered monitoring system; supervise four FSN-11 MEL specialists
- **CLA / KM:** Launched Mission CLA plan, including developing knowledge management plan and new learning questions; crowdsourced evidence gaps to plan 12 context assessments prior to new CDCS
- **GESI:** Onboarded new GESI adviser, co-developed GESI Mission Order, launched Community of Practice and internal GESI working group, initiated separate gender, ID, and GBV analyses for CDCS
- **Acting OD & Budget:** 4 weeks of combined acting OD and Budget Lead during \$1.7Bn supplemental funding negotiations with NSC and over \$60M in PO fund realignment; supervised 13 staff

USAID/Colombia Program Office – C3 Program Officer (FS 4-9)

- **Gender Adviser:** Acting Mission Gender Equity and Social Inclusion Adviser for nine months; organized a Community of Practice with partners on LGBTQI+ inclusion and Local Knowledge Summit
- **Design:** Managed four new activity designs from concept to consensus meeting, revised design Mission Order to streamline processes on hybrid contracts, buy-ins and co-creation
- **Rural Economic Development:** Advised land titling activity on use of drone imagery for flood risk analysis, outlined project-wide evaluation to assess finance and agricultural extension activities
- **Budget:** Led MRR process for FY24 budget, supported OP and CBN review of all key issue narratives

USAID/W Rotations – C3 Program Officer (FS 5-12)

- **USAID/Honduras:** Supported PPR and OP processes, revising dozens of key issue narratives
- **BRM:** Won On the Spot Award for budget data processing and visualization tool created in Python and Tableau, saving hundreds of hours of staff time in 653a negotiations
- **PPL:** Led knowledge management pilot with South Sudan Mission, including designing staff transition resources and implementation plan for improving handovers and file management in Juba

USAID/Southern Africa – Program Office Summer Payne Fellow

- Led creation and review of regional Gender Analysis for 12 countries. Continued work on a contract basis throughout the year, culminating in a 170-page informational report

Centre for European Economic Research (Mannheim, DE) – Migration Research Team Lead

- Created model to predict employment likelihood by language level for asylum seekers
- Co-authored research paper on refugee integration strategies in Rhine-Neckar region

U.S. House of Representatives, Congressman Joe Crowley – Policy Research Analyst

- Created financial analysis model for proposed retirement savings bill that was used in hearings
- Wrote 6 policy briefings on foreign policy issues for review by the Congressman

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology (Atlanta, GA) Master of Science in Computer Science

- Online program with a specialization in machine learning, including coursework on AI ethics, human-computer interaction, reinforcement learning, and advanced algorithms

Indiana State University (Terre Haute, IN) Master of Science in Mathematics, GPA: 3.85

- Thesis: A Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley (Berkeley, CA) Master of Science in Development Practice, GPA: 3.94

- Master's Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing

Heidelberg University (Heidelberg, Germany) Coursework towards MSc. in Economics

- Fulbright Research on Economic Integration of Asylum Seekers in Germany

Mercer University (Macon, GA) B.B.A. with Honors, Summa Cum Laude, GPA: 3.91

- Majors: International Business, Finance, and Economics; Minors: Development Studies

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Fellowships & Awards

Payne International Development Fellow – \$90,000 Graduate Fellowship with USAID

Fulbright Graduate Research Award – \$10,000 Research Grant and Cultural Exchange Program

Humanity in Action Senior Fellow – International Human Rights Advocacy Network

Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar – \$240,000 Undergraduate Merit Scholarship

Research Publications & Presentations

UC Berkeley: Innovations in Disaster Response Showcase – *(Berkeley, CA)*

- Autonomous Drone Deployment Grid for Improved Wildfire Response in California

UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab – *(Berkeley, CA)*

- Dimensionality Reduction for Mapping of Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices

Centre for European Economic Research – *(Mannheim, DE)* (Published Working Paper)

- “Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers” (In German)

Humanity in Action International Conference – *(Strasbourg, FR)*

- “The End of Schengen? Reforms to the Dublin Regulation and EU Asylum Policy”

National Conference on Undergraduate Research – *(Memphis, TN)*

- “Gentrification or Revitalization? Ethical Investment in Urban Property Development”

Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition – *(Cambridge, MA)*

- “OurBlock” - Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform

Volunteer Experiences

UC Berkeley, Goldman School of Public Policy Alumni Board, Board Member

- Elected alumni representative of Master of Development Practice program, supports Governance committee with diversity, equity, and inclusion efforts across graduate school

U.S. Embassy Colombia DEIA Committees / glifaa

- Co-Chair of USAID/Colombia’s DEIA Committee and the embassy’s chapter of glifaa
- Chair of the Institutional Policy and Reform Committee in the embassy’s DEIA Council

Berkeley Food Institute, Climate Policy Research Fellow

- Integrated Google Earth Engine climate data to farmland analysis app, visualized combined surface-groundwater drought risk index for spatial equity analysis of statewide policy

UC Berkeley Division of Data Sciences, Data Scholars Program

- Created and led course for over 70 advanced undergraduate data science students over four semesters on applied research methods, project management, and career planning

Additional Skills

Data Analysis and GIS Technology:

Computer Programming in Python & Java
Advanced ArcGIS, QGIS, Google Earth Engine
Advanced Analysis in Excel, Tableau, R
GSuite Process Automation and Scripting
Remote Sensing and Satellite Imagery
Econometrics and Impact Evaluation

Interagency Coordination:

Embassy Working Group Leadership
ACCOORD Point of Contact for Mission

MECLA, Design and Budget:

Budget Management and OPSMaster
Co-Creation and Local Procurement
MRR, CBN, OP Reporting Process
Design Workshop Facilitation
Pre-Ob Checklist Streamlining
Training Planning and Delivery
PPR, ABR, Ad-Hoc Reporting
Third-Party Monitoring
PIRS and AMELP Design

Other:

Spanish (3/3)
German (2/2)
Ukrainian (1/1)
COR/AOR Level 2
BHA Nexus POC
Hiring TEC Chair
Event Management
MBC Management
Cable Writing